PALLAVI RANA

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◆ SUMMARY

Strategic HR professional with 17+ years of experience in **Talent Acquisition & Management, HR Operations, and People Strategy** across high-growth and transformation-driven environments. Adept at leading end-to-end HR Operation and TA functions across **corporate setups**, **business expansion and scale-up initiatives**, **M&A transitions, startup ecosystems**, and **greenfield projects**, with a proven track record of aligning talent strategy and HR initiatives to organizational business goals.
Extensive experience in leading end-to-end Talent Acquisition and HR Operations for mid-sized global MNCs and large-scale Pan-India enterprises, spanning diverse sectors including **Telecommunications, IT, Chemicals & Fertilizers, Healthcare & Medical Devices, and Luxury Consumer Durable.**
A trusted advisor to **CXOs, business heads, and cross-functional teams** at corporate and regional levels. Recognized for delivering impactful outcomes- whether building HR from the ground up, driving enterprise-wide initiatives, managing M&A transitions, or operating as a strategic individual contributor. **My leadership style is grounded** in **clarity, collaboration, and accountability**, earning consistent trust and credibility among stakeholders.

◆ AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- **Workforce Strategy:** Workforce Planning & Forecasting, Manpower Budgeting, Salary Benchmarking, Talent Market Intelligence, Succession Planning, Talent Transformation & Change Management.
- **Talent Acquisition:** Strategic Talent Acquisition, Bulk Hiring, Large Scale Hiring, Executive & Leadership Hiring, Niche product Hiring, Sales Hiring, IT & Non-IT Hiring, Tier 1& 2 Campus Hiring, Global Talent Acquisition, Employer Value Proposition (EVP), Data-Driven Hiring (Zoho Recruit /Greenhouse ATS, LinkedIn Recruiter, Naukri RMS, Keka, Darwin Box, Power BI etc.)
- **Employee Development:** Onboarding & Induction, Learning & Development, OKR-Based Performance Management, Rewards & Recognition, Employee Engagement & Retention, HR Policies, Statutory Compliance etc.
- **Diversity Initiatives:** Diversity, Equity & Inclusion (DEI) Hiring, Employer Branding, Culture & Employee Experience.
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Stakeholder & Vendor Management, Employee Relations, Business Partnering.

◆ EMPLOYMENT DETAILS

HR Head (Talent Acquisition & HR Operation) **May 2022 – Till date**
Watergen India Pvt. Ltd. (New Delhi -India office)
An Israel-based MNC specializing in Atmospheric Water Generator (AWG) technology, operating in India through a joint venture between Watergen Ltd. and SMV Jaipuria Group. The company is redefining sustainable drinking water access through cutting-edge AWG technology catering to household, commercial, and industrial segments across B2B, B2D, and HNI clients. Its India operations are currently at a startup stage, laying the foundation for growth in this emerging sector.

Key Responsibilities: -
Spearheaded the establishment of a brand-new team at Corporate & PAN **India offices** for a **Greenfield project** from **scratch** and handling **Talent Acquisition, HR Operation** and **Strategic HR Business partner** role of **India Office.**

Talent Acquisition & Strategy

- Collaborated with the **Promoter, CEO** and **Function Heads** to design the organizational structure and finalize **manpower plans** aligned with the Annual Operating Plan **(AOP).**
- Established the Talent Acquisition function from scratch, designing hiring workflows, SOPs, job descriptions, and interview evaluation frameworks suited to a high-growth environment.
- Successfully closed critical **leadership roles (CMO, Sales Head- B2B/B2D, Service Head, Production Head)** within SLA.
- **Developed AOP-driven manpower budgeting** and workforce forecasting model post-leadership hiring, working closely with functional heads to build costed hiring plans in sync with capacity expansion.
- **Recruited, mentored and led a high-performing HR team**, fostering strong cross-functional partnerships with business and function heads to ensure HR strategies were aligned with organizational goals, enabling scalable growth and enhancing stakeholder satisfaction.
- Executed a multi-channel sourcing strategy using platforms like **LinkedIn, Naukri, iimjobs** along with **referrals, campus hiring, mass drives, consultants, and ATS tools**, ensuring a steady talent pipeline across business-critical roles.
- Achieved time-to-hire reduction from 60 to 30 days through structured hiring pipelines, and interview panel enablement.
- Hired and built a **high-volume Sales & Service team** for a luxury water-tech product, catering to both **B2B clients and HNI customers.**
- Headed the **Recruitment** of a **greenfield manufacturing plant** for managing both **white-collar and blue-collar workforce**.
- Recruited the **Production Head / Supply Chain Head /Plant HR Officer** as the first critical hire to initiate plant setup and operational planning. Drove cross-functional alignment of **HR, Production, Admin, Supply Chain** & **logistic** teams during the early project planning phase.

- Collaborated with Production Head to create an initial **phased manpower blueprint** aligned with the **production timelines** and hiring of critical workforce roles **including white & blue-collar staff** based on production scale-up plans.
- **Scaled the workforce from ground level to PAN-India presence**, building high-performing teams across corporate functions, field sales, service, and manufacturing, aligned with phased growth targets.

HR Operations

- Designed and implemented a **flexible compensation framework** through **salary benchmarking** for mid and senior-level employees, optimizing the balance between fixed, variable, and performance-linked pay components
- Structure the offer letter, appointment letter, salary structure, NDAs, and exit documentation.
- Ensured **compliance** with statutory deductions and registrations as per **Indian Labour Laws** including **Shops & Establishment Act, PF, ESIC, Professional Tax (PT), and Labour Welfare Fund (LWF).**
- Built core HR processes in a fast-paced set-up by developing **HR policies** & internal guideline as per Indian laws **(Leave, Attendance, Maternity Benefit act, Travel, POSH, code of conduct policy etc**).
- **Implemented Keka HRMS** to digitize employee lifecycle processes and improve operational efficiency.
- Developed and rolled out a structured **Induction** and **Product Training program** to support new hires and ongoing development.
- **Implemented** an OKR-based Performance Management System using Keka's **PMS module**, aligning individual and team goals with business KPIs through a structured quarterly review cycle.
- Developed and rolled out a **Manager Toolkit comprising goal-setting templates, performance review forms**, and 1-on-1 conversation guides to ensure consistency, transparency, and accountability in performance conversations.
- Spearheaded **employee engagement** through impactful initiatives such as weekly **HR Connects, festive celebrations, potlucks, Family Day** events, and **Wellness programs** nurturing a vibrant, inclusive, and collaborative startup culture.
- Introduced a **Rewards & Recognition** (R&R) program to drive appreciation across levels and improve employee morale.
- Simplified **Sales & Service** Team **Travel arrangement** and collaborated with **MakeMyTrip** to set up a centralized **Travel Desk**, reducing manual coordination and enhancing travel efficiency for Sales & Service teams across India.
- Developed and documented **HR SOPs.**

Sr Manager HR (Head HR) **Sept 2018 –April 2022**

Unicorn Denmart Ltd - (Corporate Office-New Delhi)

Unicorn Denmart Ltd (UDL) is a market leader in international dental healthcare and medical device solutions across India and the SAARC region. The company operates PAN-India offices with demo showrooms, a distributor network, and its e-commerce platform, BestDentalDeals.in.

Key Responsibilities: -

- **Talent Acquisition & Management**
  Responsible for employee end to end life cycle from hiring to exit.
  Spearheaded **end-to-end recruitment** for PAN India **Sales, Service, Marketing, Customer Service and support functions, including lateral, campus, and critical hiring.** Led workforce planning for the expansion of an e-commerce business, aligning talent strategy with growth objectives. Leveraged sourcing strategies through Naukri, LinkedIn, referrals, Tier-2 colleges i.e. Dental Medical colleges, Engineering, ITI / Polytechnic walk-ins, and consultant networks.
  Developed recruitment dashboards and conducted regular reviews with BU heads to track hiring metrics and align with business goals.
- **Learning & Development**
  Designed and launched **Unicorn Academy-LMS** a structured, in-house learning platform tailored for Sales capability enhancement. **Built role-based induction, technical product training**, and service-learning modules in collaboration with internal product specialists and trainers. Led post-training evaluation to ensure continuous improvement in knowledge transfer and performance uplift.
- **Performance Management**
  Instituted 30-60-90-day onboarding plans and integrated **OKR-based performance tracking** into the PMS framework for functional alignment. Managed quarterly and annual performance cycles (integrated with LMS + PMS). Facilitated appraisal workshops and coaching for people managers.
- **Succession Planning & Talent Management**
  Drove identification and development of high-potential talent via **Talent Acceleration Program (TAP)**, with structured IDPs and career conversations. Prepare them for future leadership roles or critical business positions.
  Conducted stay interviews and readiness assessments for critical roles to strengthen leadership pipeline and minimize attrition risk.
- **Employee Engagement & Culture Building**
  Curated and delivered a strategic engagement calendar featuring **rewards & recognition programs,** festive events, and a structured grievance redressal mechanism.
- Streamlined **Induction & Onboarding** processes. Ensured seamless documentation and new joiner handholding. Draft HR policies including Leave, Travel, R&R, Long service, study assistance, child education etc.
- Implemented **Darwinbox HRMS** for HR process automation.

- Leveraged Darwinbox HRMS across all key modules—including Core HR, Attendance & Leave, Payroll & Compliance, Performance Management (OKRs), Recruitment (ATS), Learning & Development (LMS), Employee Engagement (R&R, surveys), Helpdesk, Expense Management, and HR Analytics—to drive end-to-end HR digitization and enhance process efficiency, compliance, and employee experience."
- **Organizational Development (OD) & Change Management**
  Launched structured **learning journeys** via *Unicorn Academy*, supporting continuous improvement and upskilling across roles.
  Building **competency frameworks** for Sales & Service and designed Unicorn Academy to support a role-based learning journey. Over time, linked each training path to core competencies like product expertise, selling skills, or coaching ability which helped in assess skill gaps and feed into performance evaluations.
  Embedded **OKRs** to align team goals with business outcomes.
  Enabled **leadership development** and succession plans
  Led **change management** initiatives related to onboarding, PMS, HRMS, and internal learning platforms providing manager enablement through training, tools, and ongoing support.

Deputy Manager HR **Apr 2017- Aug 2018**
Paradeep Phosphates Ltd (ADVENTZ Group)- Corporate Office -Gurgaon
ADVENTZ is the USD 3 billion Group, partnered by world leaders in various areas of enterprise and has significant presence in agriculture, engineering & infrastructure, real estate, consumer durables and finance services.

Key Responsibilities: -
Talent Acquisition
- Responsible for **Corporate office** middle, **Senior & Leadership level hiring.**
- Handling the PAN India office senior level hiring wherever required i.e. Bangalore/Mangalore /Pune/Goa/ Paradeep/Mumbai/Dubai (UAE) from corporate office.
- Flagship companies hiring wherever required i.e. Paradeep Phosphates Ltd/Zuari Agro Chemicals Ltd /Mangalore Chemicals Fertilizers Ltd/ Zuari Management Services Ltd/Indian Furniture products Ltd/Simon India etc.
- Periodic review meetings with the BU heads and hiring managers to discuss hiring targets and share the recruitment dashboard to let them aware about the hiring status.
- Hire through various modes with the help of various channels i.e. Employee Referral, Head hunting, walk ins drive, Tier 1 College campus drive, Consultant, IJP, Job Portals (Naukri, Times Job, LinkedIn) etc.
- Handling the statutory compliance activity of new flagship company Zuari Management Services Ltd of Adventz group.
- Introducing the strategic Induction & On boarding program at group level from corporate office.
- Designs the JD and salary positioning after taking necessary approvals from functional heads.
- Responsible for salary positioning, negotiation and offer-rollout.

Assistant Manager (India- Lead HR) **Apr 2011 – Mar 2017**
AIRCOM International India Pvt Ltd (TEOCO Corporation). Gurgaon -India Office.
TEOCO headquartered in US –Fairfax is an MNC a leading provider of analytics, assurance and optimization solutions to over 300 communication service providers (CSPs) and OEMs worldwide and Off shore Consulting. TEOCO take over AIRCOM International in Dec 2013.

Key Responsibilities: -
- **Talent Acquisition**
  Handling & Leading **PAN India & Dubai (UAE)** end-to-end recruitment for **IT & non-IT** including lateral, bulk, and campus hiring for diverse skills such as Java, C++, C#, Unix/Linux, Oracle, PL/SQL, Pre-Sales, Quality, R&D, Offshore Consulting, RF Engineering, 24*7 Support Engineer, call centre, etc
  Launched a **pipeline hiring process** to meet fluctuating business needs, resulting in **20% hires** from emerging **tech domains**.
  Sourced talent through **multiple channels** – job portals (Naukri, LinkedIn, Times Jobs), Boolean search, referrals, consultants, and campus drives.
  Designed **technical evaluation** questionnaires in collaboration with engineering teams to standardize screening.
  Managed **salary negotiations** and final offer rollouts.
  Trained and led **recruitment team**, assigned targets, tracked progress, and ensured timely delivery.
  Drove **recruitment metrics** (TAT, cost-per-hire, offer-to-join ratio) and introduced ATS and tracking tools for data-driven hiring and report on attrition analysis.
  Conducted **walk-in and campus hiring** drives across key locations.
  Handled **manpower planning and budgeting** aligned with business strategy.
  Facilitated **exit interviews** and shared actionable insights with leadership.
  Launched **Employee Referral Policy** to strengthen internal sourcing.

- **Vendor Management**
  Built and maintained a robust **vendor network**, negotiated terms & agreements and ensured SLA adherence.
  Managed invoice validation and payment coordination.
  Liaised with background verification **(BVG)** and onboarding vendors.

- **Induction & Onboarding**
  Delivered **HR induction** sessions covering policies, culture, and processes.
  Ensured seamless documentation and new joiner handholding.
- **Performance Management**
  Managed full **PMS cycle** using **Halogen** Software, including training and communication to managers.
  Initiated **goal setting (90-day plans)** and facilitated **quarterly and annual reviews**.
  Compiled and analyzed performance data for appraisal decisions.
- **Employee Relations & Retention**
  Managed HR support for over **500 employees**, addressing grievances and engagement initiatives.
  Conducted **HR Connect sessions** and skip-level meetings to promote transparent communication.
  Organized **town halls, monthly team meets, festival celebrations**, and **R&R programs** to boost morale.
- **Payroll & Compliance**
  Reviewed and updated India **HR policies** and Employee Handbook in line with global HR standards.
  Maintained monthly **HR reports** and dashboards via HRIS tools.
  Reviewed **payroll inputs, salary registers**, and worked with third-party vendors for accurate payroll processing.
  Ensured **PF/EPF compliance**, statutory adherence, and supported **POSH training and implementation**.

❖ **Sr. Executive HR -Gurgaon** **July 2008- April 2011**
Videocon Telecommunication Ltd - Gurgaon
Key Responsibilities: - Talent Acquisition
• Actively supported the launch of a new telecom business for **Videocon**, partnering with Hiring Managers to understand and fulfil hiring requirements.
• Designed Job Descriptions and managed end-to-end recruitment including interviews, selection, salary negotiation, and offer roll-out.• Managed and coordinated with **external recruitment consultants/vendors**, ensuring timely closures and adherence to quality and cost parameters. • Led campus hiring and bulk recruitment across **Finance, Marketing, Sales, IT, and Network** functions for Circle and Corporate offices. • Successfully closed **500+ positions within six months** on a PAN India basis.

❖ **Executive HR** **July 2007 – July 2008**
Idea Cellular Ltd – New Delhi
Key Responsibilities: - Talent Acquisition
• Sourced, screened, and tracked manpower requirements, ensuring timely delivery against hiring commitments.
• Headhunted and screened profiles from multiple channels including **job portals, IJP, walk-in drive, campus, consultant and referrals**. • Coordinated and scheduled interviews between candidates and interview panels across departments and time zones.
• Managed large-scale monthly hiring of **200–400 Customer Care Executives** for **24×7 inbound and outbound call centre operations**.

ACHIEVEMENTS

❖ Watergen India
Established a brand-new team for a luxury consumer durable brand in water technology.
Individually hired the Leadership team and scaled the workforce from scratch for all level of hiring and build end to end HR Operations & process from scratch.

❖ Unicorn Denmart Ltd
Outstanding Contribution to Organizational Development- Revamped Recruitment for Sales, Service & Customer Relationship roles through Tier 1/2 Dental, Management, Engineering, and ITI Pusa colleges, workforce planning to support e-commerce business expansion, launched Unicorn Academy (LMS), implemented a robust PMS, enhanced Rewards & Recognition, and digitized HR with HRMS.

❖ AIRCOM International (TEOCO)
TEO-Star of the month -Talent Acquisition & Employee Engagement
Recognized for multiple times ensure timely recruitment & quality hiring in line with business workforce plans and driving impactful employee engagement initiatives. Handling the closure of 100 -200 hires per month.

Best employee 'E3 Award' – (Empowerment, Employee-Ownership, and Excellence Award)
For Outstanding effort in Change management & Strategic HR activity during AIRCOM & TEOCO Merger & Acquisition, Implement strategy for **attrition management, employee retention, and engagement.**

❖ Videocon Telecommunication Ltd
High-Volume Recruitment Achievement
Successfully closed **500+ roles in six months** across PAN India, supporting critical business operations through timely talent delivery.

◈ CERTIFICATIONS

- Certificate in Generative AI, Recruiting and Talent Acquisition (2025)
- Certificate in Applied AI for Human Resource (2025)
- Certified Talent Management Analyst – Middle Earth HR (2020)
- Digital Marketing Certificate – Digital Vidya (2019)
- Recruitment & Sourcing Workshop – Source Pro (2015)
- Advanced Diploma in French – CCS University (2003)

◈ EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. in Psychology**
  Specialization: Organizational and Industrial Psychology
  Jain (Deemed-to-be University) | 2024 – 2026 (Pursuing)
- **Post Graduate Certificate in Human Resource Management (PGCHRM)**
  Xavier School of Management (XLRI), Jamshedpur | 2016 – 2017
- **Master of Business Administration (MBA)**
  Specialization: Human Resources & Marketing
  Rai Business School (MDU) | 2004 – 2006
- **Bachelor of Commerce (B. Com)**
  Subjects: Business, Accounts, Economics
  Meerut College (Chaudhary Charan Singh University) | 2001 – 2004
- **12th Standard (CBSE)**
  Stream: Commerce, Maths, Economics
  Meerut Public Girls School | 2001
- **10th Standard (CBSE)**
  Meerut Public Girls School | 1999

◈ PERSONAL DETAILS

DOB	:	25 Sept 1984
Marital Status	:	Married
Languages Known	:	English, Hindi and French
Passport	:	Valid up to 2036
Current Location	:	Gurgaon (Open to relocate)